# Vittoria Iannotta

vittoriaiannotta | https://vittoriaiannotta.github.io/ |
vittoria.iannotta@hec.edu | +393468219805

## Research Interests

I am a researcher working in macro-finance and banking. I study how banks and firms interact in the market for credit: what determines loan pricing, how credit is allocated across firms, and how monetary policy affects equilibrium outcomes.

## Education

PhD candidate in Economics at **HEC Paris** 2023 - present

**Advisor:** Prof. Gaetano Gaballo

- Summer 2025, Summer Graduate Program in honor of Ivan Jaccard,
  Financial Research Division, **European Central Bank**
  References: Simone Manganelli, David Marqués-Ibáñez
- Fall 2024, Visiting Scholar, **University of Pennsylvania**, Department of Economics.
  Sponsor: Prof. Guillermo Ordonez
- Spring 2023, Visiting Scholar, **Banque de France**, Financial Economics Research Division.
  Worked with *fintech-related data* and explored potential empirical applications.

M.S. in Management Sciences - **HEC Paris** 2021 - 2023

M.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University**
Thesis Supervisor: Prof. Francesco Giavazzi 2017 - 2020

B.S. in Economic and Social Sciences - **Bocconi University** 2014 - 2017

## Job Market Paper

**Default risk surprises and banks' loan pricing.**
Using one million loans matched to firms' public credit ratings, I show that interest rate differentials unexplained by observables at issuance contain information about future changes in firms' default probability. On average, firms whose default probability increases by 1 p.p. one year after loan issuance were charged an otherwise unexplained 0.04 p.p. rate premium at issuance; the premium doubles for younger and smaller firms, strengthens in crises and at longer maturities. Information available to banks at loan issuance arises as a potential driver of interest rate differentials and of the positive relationship between rates and default risk. Yet, it is not necessary: the same pattern can emerge in a market with search frictions. I bring these forces together in a search model of loan pricing with asymmetric information in which banks see an imperfect public signal on firms' risk types. In equilibrium, the positive rate-risk relationship can arise either when the public signal is sufficiently informative to tell apart borrowers, or, despite an uninformative signal, when banks' pricing strategies induce partial separation. I use a calibrated version of the model to rationalize the empirical findings. I find that banks are informed and separate borrowers in good credit rated markets, and they are uninformed and pool borrowers in bad credit rated ones.

## References

**Prof. Gaetano Gaballo** (Advisor)
Professor of Economics, HEC Paris
gaballo@hec.fr

**Prof. Refet S. Gürkaynak**
Professor of Economics, Bilkent University
refet@bilkent.edu.tr

**Prof. Johan Hombert**
Professor of Finance, HEC Paris
hombert@hec.fr

**Prof. Benjamin Lester**
Vice President and Economist,
Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia
Benjamin.Lester@phil.frb.org

## Presentations

The **Wharton School, Finance** (Internal presentation), Fall 2024. **Paris Macro Workshop**, May 2025. **European Central Bank** (Internal Seminar), May 2025. Economics Letters Summer School in Macro-Finance at **Bocconi SDA**, July 2025. **ICBFS Conference**, Piacenza, Sep 2025. 4th PhD and Post-Doctoral Workshop, Naples School of Economics (NSE) of the **University of Naples Federico II**, Sep 2025. 9th Dauphine Finance PhD Workshop, **Université Paris Dauphine - PSL**, June 2026. **European Summer Symposium in Financial Markets** (Evening Sessions), Jul 2026. **Fourth Women in Central Banking Workshop**, Banco de Mexico, (scheduled Nov $6^{th}$).

## Work Experience

**Research Analyst, European Central Bank** Apr 2020 - Jun 2021

*Title:* Traineeship (1 year) + Research Analyst (3 months). *Area:* Monetary Analysis.
*Main Activities:* Data collection (Orbis, ECB series), macroeconometric analysis of time series data (including monetary aggregates, bank lending volumes and interest rates), Microeconometric analysis of firm panel data (balance sheets, firm-bond links). *References:* Fédéric Holm-Hadulla

## Teaching Experience

**Lecturer, Introduction to Macroeconomics.** 2022, 2023

*Program*: MSc in Economics and Finance, HEC Paris. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.32/5 (2023/24).

**Teaching assistant for Prof. Michau, Advanced Macroeconomics.** 2023, 2024, 2025

*Program*: MSc in Economics, Ecole Polytechnique. *Latest teaching evaluations*: 4.22/5 (2024/25)

**Teaching assistant for Prof Ai-Ting Goh, Macroeconomics.** 2024, 2025

*Program*: MBA simulation games, HEC Paris.

**Instructor for ESSEC IRENE France, Game Theory for Negotiation** 2026

*Program*: One-day Professional Training, delivered at the Council of the European Union.

## Skills

**Datasets experience:**
*Credit registries*: French Credit Registries, P2P lenders registry (ACPR, Banque de France)
*Firm-level data*: National balance sheet data (FIBEN, Bank of France), Orbis,Amadeus (BvD)
*Financial analysis*: Eikon, Datastream

*Macroeconomic analysis*: ECB series, BSI, MIR

**Statistical Packages and Programming:**

| | |
|---|---|
| *R, Stata, Matlab* | (Advanced) data management, statistical and econometric analysis, visualisation |
| *Python* | (Advanced) structural estimation, model simulations, visualization, webscraping. |
| *SQL* | (Intermediate) data management |
| *SPSS, Eviews* | (Basic) data management, statistical and econometric analysis |
| *Microsoft Office* | PowerPoint, Word, Excel |